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Ga
Gallium

31 31 39
State: Solid
Discovery: 1875

Forms

Diaspore

The needle-like crystals *form on the surface.*

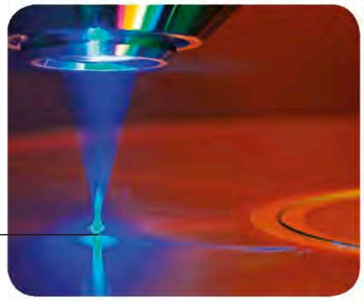
Cube of melting gallium

Pure gallium *has a very low melting point.*

Uses

Thermometer

This medical thermometer *uses a gallium alloy instead of mercury.*



Blu-ray disc

A gallium laser *is used to read Blu-ray discs.*

Red LED lights

The red LED *gets its colour from gallium compounds.*

Opportunity rover

The solar panels *powering this rover, which is exploring Mars, contain gallium and arsenic.*

Gallium melts at just 29°C (84.2°F), which means it soon becomes liquid when held in the hand. This element is found in small amounts in ores of zinc and aluminium, such as **diaspore**. **Pure gallium** is isolated when the other elements from this ore are extracted.

Gallium has a number of uses. It is mixed with indium and tin to form a liquid alloy called galinstan, which can be used in **thermometers**. Gallium is also found in **Blu-ray lasers**, **LEDs**, and some solar panels, such as those on NASA's Mars **rovers**.